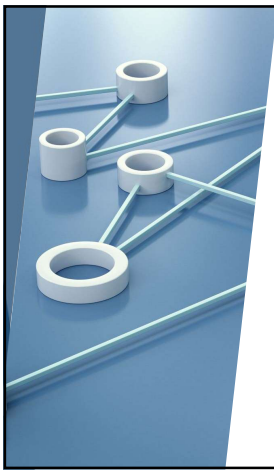
AI Classification

"A Practical Use"

1



AI Interaction

Three General Classifications

2

Three "Main" Classifications of AI Use

A useful shorthand is:

- **AI Assistance** — *AI supports your thinking.*
- **AI Enabled / Collaboration** — *AI works with you.*
- **AI Embedded** — **Three Classifications of AI Use**

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1 Three Classifications of AI Use

A simple way to understand how AI is used.

These are different modes of use, not a better-to-worse ladder.

AI Assistance

AI supports your thinking and understanding, while you remain the primary actor.

Common uses:

- term definitions
- research and summarization
- reflection / journaling feedback
- high-level design or code analysis

AI advises. You decide.

AI Enabled / Collaboration

AI works interactively with you on targeted tasks, design, and creation.

Common uses:

- code snippets and debugging help
- app and database design
- full application development
- iterative task completion

AI works with you.

AI Embedded

AI is integrated into an application or workflow and operates inside the tool itself.

Common uses:

- AI in PowerPoint or Word
- in-app writing or editing help
- workflow automation inside tools
- hidden single-agent or multi-agent systems

AI works within the system.

Increasing integration with the work

Assistance = support your thinking. **Enabled / Collaboration** = work with you. **Embedded** = work inside the system.

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In Practice, the Boundaries Overlap

The three classifications are useful because they simplify Human-AI interaction into recognizable modes.

- Reality is less tidy.

A single interaction or project may move between all three.

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Really, They Overlap!

2 In Practice, the Boundaries Overlap

Real use blends assistance, collaboration, and embedded capabilities.

AI ASSISTANCE

AI supports your understanding and thinking.

- Ask questions
- Get explanations
- Research topics
- Summarize content
- Reflect and reframe
- Analyze or explain code
- High-level planning

You lead. AI assists.

From Assistance to Collaboration

- Research becomes a drafted outline
- Analysis leads to suggested solutions or snippets
- Reflection informs structured plans

AI ENABLED / COLLABORATION

AI works with you to create, build, and solve.

- Generate code or content
- Iterate and refine together
- Design databases and systems
- Build features or full apps
- Test, debug, and improve
- Targeted task completion

You collaborate. AI contributes.

From Collaboration to Embedded

- Agent works in your repository or tools
- AI uses app-level tools or actions
- Human-guided agentic workflows

AI EMBEDDED

AI is integrated into the application or workflow.

- Integrated in apps (agents, copilots, features)
- Performs actions within your system
- Automates workflows
- Multi-agent systems under the hood
- You interact with the app, AI works within it

AI operates within the system you use.

Why overlap is normal — A single project or conversation often moves across modes. You might research (assistance), co-create (collaboration), and then use or deploy (embedded).

Modes are fluid. You choose what fits the task.

The goal isn't to stay in one mode — *It's to use the right level of AI for the right part of the work.*

You stay in control.

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A "Fourth" Classification!

AI Creation/Development	*This requires more in depth knowledge of:*
• Creating LLM's (Large Language Models) • Creating CAG's & RAG's and Other types	• Algorithmic processing • Neural Networks • Types of AI models: • Descriptive/Analytical • Predictive • Generative • Model Training and extensive Testing methodologies • Data Analytics/Science

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Agency & Interaction

The overlap becomes easier to understand when the three classifications are examined using two independent dimensions.

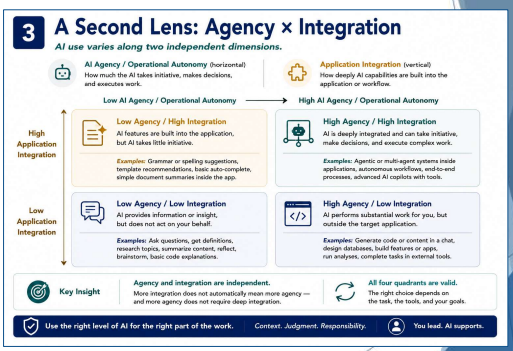
- The first is ***AI Agency / Operational Autonomy***
- The second is ***Application Integration***.

These dimensions explain why two AI systems can belong to the same broad classification while behaving very differently.

The two dimensions create four useful regions…

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A&I Relationship



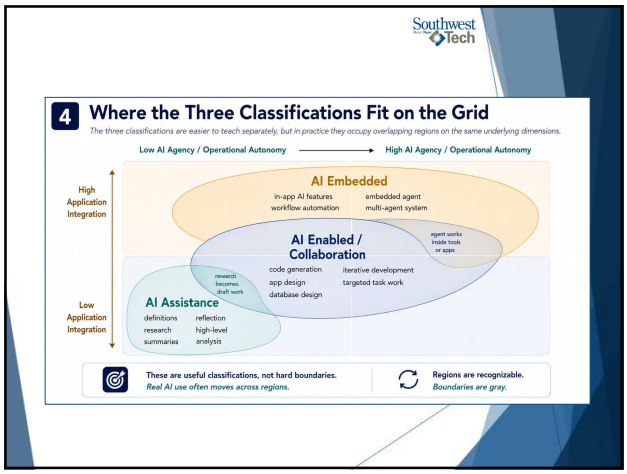
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Where the Three Classifications Fit on the Grid
The three classifications are easier to teach separately, but in practice they occupy overlapping regions on the same underlying dimensions.
Low AI Agency / Operational Autonomy
High AI Agency / Operational Autonomy
High Application Integration
Low Application Integration
AI Embedded
in-app AI features
workflow automation
embedded agent
multi-agent system
AI Enabled / Collaboration
agent works inside tools or apps
code generation
app design
database design
iterative development
targeted task work
research becomes draft work
AI Assistance
definitions
research
summaries
reflection
high-level
analysis
These are useful classifications, not hard boundaries.
Real AI use often moves across regions.
Regions are recognizable.
Boundaries are gray.

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Conclusion
Artificial intelligence is not used in only one way.
Sometimes AI explains.
Sometimes it collaborates.
Sometimes it operates within the systems people use.
And increasingly, a single workflow may move among all three.
The three classifications provide an accessible starting point:
Assistance → Collaboration → Embedded
The Agency × Integration model reveals the deeper structure beneath them.
✓ The important lesson is not to force every AI use case into one perfectly defined box.

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Thank you!
Have Fun!

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